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AWARDS AND RECOGNITION

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This publication implements DAFMAN36-2806, *Military Awards: Criteria and Procedures and* DODI1400.25V451_DAFI36-1004, *Department of The Air Force Civilian Recognition Program.* The instruction defines responsibilities and establishes procedures for the Air Force Sustainment Center's (AFSC) process for administering honorary, functional, and federal/nonfederal awards. This guidance applies to military and civilian personnel across AFSC. The provisions of this instruction apply to all organizations within the AFSC. Ensure all records created as a result of processes prescribed in this publication are maintained in accordance with Air Force Instruction 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program*, and disposed of in accordance with (IAW) the Air Force Records Information Management System Records Disposition Schedule (RDS) located at **https://www.my.af.mil/afrims/afrims/afrims/rims.cfm**.

Refer recommended changes and questions about this publication to the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) using Air Force Information Management Tool (AF IMT) 847, Recommendation for Change of Publication; route AF IMT 847s through the appropriate chain of command to AFSC Directorate of Manpower and Personnel.

SUMMARY OF CHANGES

This revision rescinds the Diversity and Inclusion requirements for awards scoring panels to be in compliance with Executive Order 14151, *Ending Radical and Wasteful Government DEI Programs and Preferencing*, 20 January 2025.

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Chapter 1

GENERAL INFORMATION

1.1. Overview. The Air Force Sustainment Center (AFSC) awards program is intended to recognize civilian and military personnel for their accomplishments and commitment to excellence. The AFSC workforce is our strongest asset and achieving critical missions could not be accomplished without them. Recognizing and rewarding personnel plays a vital role in a strong and successful workforce. This instruction defines responsibilities and establishes procedures for administering honorary, functional, and federal/nonfederal awards. For additional information on specific awards, see DoDI1400.25v451_DAFI36-1004, *Civilian Recognition Program,* DAFMAN 36-2806, *Military Awards,* and DAFI 36-3108 *Memorialization Program.*

1.2. Scope. This guide defines awards criteria, qualifications, nominations, and the selection process across AFSC.

1.3. Point of Contact: Direct questions concerning the AFSC Awards Program to AFSC/A1K. Email the AFSC Awards Program Workflow AFSC/**DZP.Workflow@us.af.mil**.

Chapter 2

ROLES AND RESPONSIBILITIES

2.1. AFSC/A1K. AFSC/A1K is the Awards Program Manager for AFSC. AFSC/A1K will:

2.1.1. Manage awards submitted in the Enterprise Task Management Software Solution (ETMS2) system from Air Force Materiel Command (AFMC).

2.1.2. Coordinate and process honorary and length of service awards that require AFSC and/or AFMC-level approval.

2.1.3. Solicit award nomination board members from AFSC units.

2.1.4. Train and provide award requirements to AFSC organizational award liaison(s).

2.1.5. Manage ETMS2 taskings.

2.1.5.1. AFSC/A1K is the Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) for all TMT taskings pertaining to awards that are issued from AFMC. If required, will request a change of OPR through AFSC Workflow.

2.1.5.2. Assign Office of Coordinating Responsibility (OCR) to AFSC organizations and update the ETMS2 with requirements/suspense date.

2.1.5.3. Correspond with HQ AFMC if additional information or clarification is required and provide feedback to organizational award liaison(s).

2.1.6. Manage AFSC Awards SharePoint site.

2.1.6.1. Ensure organizational award liaison(s) are given access to the AFSC Awards SharePoint site and provide training as needed.

2.1.6.2. Update award criteria, suspense dates, and package uploads and ensure additional requirements are accurately reflected on the site.

2.1.6.3. Update award winners when notification is received.

2.1.7. Process Awards.

2.1.7.1. Review submissions and ensure packages are complete.

2.1.7.2. Forward enlisted packages to AFSC/CCC for review/coordination prior to submission of eSSS.

2.1.7.3. Generate eSSS and route through the appropriate chain of command to obtain approval and submission of AFSC award nomination(s).

2.1.7.4. Provide guidance and assistance on processing length of service awards (40, 50, and 60 years), and any honorary awards requiring AFSC-level or above approval.

2.2. Commanders/Directors, Senior Leaders and Managers.

2.2.1. Recognize accomplishments and contributions made by the civilian and military workforce.

2.2.2. Appoint awards liaison(s) within their organization and notify AFSC/A1K of selectee.

2.2.3. Assemble a panel to board internal nomination packages, as required. Reference **paragraph 2.2.2**.

2.2.4. Provide panel member(s) for Center-level boarding when required.

2.3. Air Force Personnel Center (AFPC).

2.3.1. Provide guidance on monetary and time-off incentive awards for all serviced employees.

2.3.2. Process requests for personnel action on all time-off and monetary awards.

2.4. Civilian Personnel Section (CPS).

2.4.1. Provide guidance and assistance on processing all length of service awards (10-, 20-, 30-, 40-, and 50-years).

2.4.2. Assist with submission of honorary awards requiring AFSC-level or below approval, as required.

2.4.3. Maintain an adequate supply of medals for serviced population as stipulated in DODI1400.24V451_DAFI36-1004, *Civilian Recognition Program,* Appendix 3 to Enclosure 3.

2.4.4. Update an employee's personnel data records once a copy of an approved incentive award is received. **NOTE: Only awards listed in** DODI1400.24V451_DAFI36-1004, Appendix 3 to Enclosure 3, **will be entered into DCPDS.**

2.5. Air Force Sustainment Center Command Chief (AFSC/CCC).

2.5.1. Coordinate on Enlisted award submissions, as required.

2.5.2. Assemble a panel to board enlisted packages when required.

2.5.3. Report names of panel members to AFSC/A1K.

2.5.4. Secure annual award trophies for AFSC recipients.

2.6. Organizational Award Liaison(s).

2.6.1. Establish, maintain, promote, administer, and process awards for their organization's program.

2.6.2. Forward questions or information requiring clarification for specific awards to AFSC/A1K or the CPS as appropriate.

2.6.3. Review award packages to confirm nominee(s) meet award criteria. Ensure packages are accurate, contain all required documents as indicated on tasking, and ready to be submitted for further competition.

2.6.4. The award authority will provide board members nomination packages consisting of only the DAF Form 1206 or Narrative Write-up.

2.6.5. Upload nominations onto the AFSC Award SharePoint or annotate a negative response into the appropriate ETMS2 tasking for all awards that are tasked through the ETMS2 system.

2.6.6. Will order and maintain stock of medal sets as stipulated in DODI1400.24V451_DAFI36-1004, *Civilian Recognition Program*, Appendix 3 to Enclosure 3, presentation folders and certificates for honorary awards and decorations approved for personnel in their organization.

2.7. Award Selection Boards. With the exception for the procedures identified in **Chapter 4**, Annual Awards, the following will be the board responsibilities.

2.7.1. Board members for civilian and officer categories will typically be comprised of GS-14/NH-03 (EOCS 76 or higher)/Major and above personnel. Enlisted board members will be comprised of Senior Noncommissioned Officers (E-7 and above).

2.7.2. All boards will consist of at least three members and each board member will be at least equivalent or one rank/pay-grade above the highest-ranking nominee in any category.

2.7.3. The award authority at every level will solicit for board members. This applies to all boards for military and civilian awards and special trophies.

2.7.4. AFSC/CCC will provide names to AFSC/A1KD to board enlisted packages.

2.7.5. Board members for functional awards will include subject matter experts.

2.7.6. Once board members have been determined, AFSC/A1KD will forward nominations to be rated, along with a score sheet, and any other relevant information to include the suspense date.

2.7.7. AFSC/A1KD will tally score sheets to determine AFSC nominee(s).

2.8. Notification of AFSC or Higher-Level Nominees.

2.8.1. Unless special notification is requested by AFSC/CC/CA/CD/DS/CCC, AFSC/A1KD will inform the workflows and organizational awards liaison(s), who submitted a nomination, of the AFSC nominee(s) going forward for further competition.

2.8.2. AFSC/A1KD will upload winners onto the AFSC Awards SharePoint Site to provide a reference for past award nominees/winners.

2.8.3. Upon notification of the AFMC or higher-level award winners, AFSC workflow will notify AFSC Awards Manager. The AFSC Awards Manager will then notify the appropriate leadership and the organizational awards liaison(s), of outcome and then upload nominees/winners on the AFSC Awards SharePoint Site. AFSC/CCS will typically prepare a congratulatory letter to be signed by AFSC/CC/CA.

2.8.4. AFSC/A1KD will notify organizational awards liaison(s) when their nominee(s) have been selected as the AFSC nominee and nomination(s) will be forwarded to the MAJCOM-level. It will be left to the discretion of the wing/complex/directorate CC/CL to provide a congratulatory letter to notify the nominee of their selection.

2.8.5. If an AFSC nominee wins at AFMC or higher level, they will typically receive a congratulatory letter from AFSC/CC/CA.

Chapter 3

AWARDS

3.1. Annual Awards. All AFSC organizations will participate in an awards recognition program. In addition to organizational and installation awards program, AFSC Annual Awards Program is defined in **chapter 4**.

3.2. Federal/Nonfederal Awards. Federal/Nonfederal awards are usually tasked from HQ AFMC through the ETMS2 system and are processed IAW applicable regulations and/or guidance. AFSC/A1KD will task organizations through the ETMS2 system for nominations, advise on requirements/eligibilities, and establish suspense dates.

3.3. Functional Awards. Functional awards are processed IAW applicable regulations and are typically tasked directly to the organizations and not through the AFSC Awards Program Manager. Organizational Award Liaison(s) will advise AFSC/A1KD of award winners at the HQ AFMC or higher level to publish onto the AFSC Awards SharePoint site.

3.4. Honorary Awards. Honorary awards are to be processed IAW DODI1400.24V451_DAFI36-1004, *Civilian Recognition Program*, Appendix 3 to Enclosure 3. Approval authorities are listed in **Table 3.1** and below. Awards requiring AFSC-level coordination or approval must be submitted on eSSS through organization chain of command to AFSC/A1KD for further coordination, approval, and processing. AFSC/A1KD and/or the CPS will provide assistance as needed.

Table 3.1. Civilian Honorary Awards Approval Authority.

Decorations					
(An "X" in a column indicates approval authority for the decoration in the heading.)	**Outstanding Civilian Career Service Award**	**Meritorious Civilian Service Award**	**Command Civilian Award for Valor**	**Exemplary Civilian Service Award**	**Air Force Civilian Achievement Award**
Center commander and civilian director equivalent	**X**	**X**	**X**	**X**	**X**
Center vice commander (colonel and above) and civilian director equivalent		**X**		**X**	**X**
Wing commander (colonel and above) and civilian director equivalent		**X**		**X**	**X**
Wing vice commander (colonel and above) and civilian director equivalent		**X**		**X**	**X**
Group (or equivalent) commander and vice commander and civilian equivalents (regardless of grade)		**X**		**X**	**X**
Squadron commander (regardless of grade) and civilian director equivalent				**X**	**X**

3.5. Military Awards, Decorations and Trophies. Military Awards, Decorations and Special Trophies are to be processed IAW DAFMAN 36-2806, *Military Awards and DAFI 36-3108, Memorialization Program*. AFSC/CSS is responsible for the processing and requirements for formal military decorations. AFSC/A1DF will provide support and advice to the Senior Raters for military decorations in accordance with DAFMAN 36-2806.

3.6. Monetary Awards. IAW DODI1400.24V451_DAFI36-1004, *Civilian Recognition Program*, each activity should budget a percentage of its annual civilian pay budget to cover monetary awards given for accomplishments outside of normal performance evaluation recognition (to include Notable Achievement Awards and Special Act or Service Awards (SA/SA). Unit resource advisors/managers must validate funds are available. Additional nomination information can be found in DoDI1400.25v451_DAFI 36-1004, *Civilian Recognition Program, Enclosure 3, Procedures.* AFSC SA/SA approval authorities are listed below.

3.6.1. SA/SA awards between $501 to $1000 may be approved by Squadron Commanders, Materiel Leaders, or equivalent Civilian Leaders and above: The 2-letter (OB, OM, FM, etc.) would be acceptable for approval level.

3.6.2. SA/SA awards between $1001 - $1500 may be approved by Group Commanders, Senior Materiel Leaders, or equivalent Civilian Leaders and above: The ALC/CC/CD/DV and Home and Staff Directorates would be the acceptable level of approval.

3.6.2.1. **78ABW ONLY.** SA/SA awards between $1501 - $2500 may be approved by the 78 ABW Vice Commander and/or 78 ABW Director of Staff.

3.6.3. SA/SA awards between $1501 - $10000 will be approved at the Center commander, vice commander, and/or executive director level.

3.6.4. The Installation Commander and/or civilian equivalent director still retain approval authority for SA/SA awards between $501 - $ 10000 IAW DODI1400.24V451_DAFI36-1004, Civilian Recognition Program.

3.7. Time-Off Awards. Time-Off Awards (TOA) are to be processed IAW DODI1400.24V451_DAFI36-1004, *Civilian Recognition Program*. Management must take special care to ensure the employee is not rewarded twice for the same performance.

3.7.1. Immediate supervisors may approve a TOA up to one working day without review and approval of a higher official. An award in excess of one day must be approved by the employee's second-level supervisor.

3.7.2. The maximum amount of time-off that may be approved for any single contribution is 40 hours. Employees working a typical 80-hour pay period may be awarded a total time-off of 80 hours during any leave year.

3.7.3. Awarded time-off should be scheduled within 90 calendar days after the effective date of the award. Employees forfeit any time-off not used within one year from the effective date. Unused time-off awards are not transferred from the Air Force to another DoD component or to another Federal agency. In addition, employees coming from another DoD department or Federal agency may not transfer a TOA to the Air Force.

3.7.4. Time-off award RPAs will be processed by the organizations and should follow the guidance in AFPC *Awards Guidance for LCC Bases & HAF OL.*

Chapter 4

AFSC ANNUAL AWARDS PROGRAM

4.1. Criteria: The Annual AFSC Awards Program is to recognize AFSC's best. Award nominees must demonstrate superior and sustained performance during the period from 1 January through 31 December. One Category Award winner will be selected from the nine AFSC organizational units (OC-ALC, OO-ALC, WR-ALC, 72 ABW, 75 ABW, 78 ABW, 448 SCMW, 635 SCOW and Home and Staff – {Home and Staff includes all of the two letter Directorates}).

4.1.1. AFSC members may be nominated for awards in the following categories:

4.1.1.1. Military Award Categories:

4.1.1.1.1. AMN (E-1 through E-4).

4.1.1.1.2. NCO (E-5 through E-6).

4.1.1.1.3. SNCO (E-7 through E-9).

4.1.1.1.4. First Sergeant (E-7 through E-9).

4.1.1.1.5. CGO (O-1 through O-3).

4.1.1.1.6. FGO (O-4 through O-5).

4.1.1.2. Civilian Categories:

4.1.1.2.1. Category I: GS-01 through GS-08; Acquisition Demonstration: NH-01; NJ-01 through NJ-02; NK-01 through NK-02; Federal Wage System: WG-01 through WG-09; WL-01 through WL-07; WS-01 through WS-05; Non-appropriated Fund: NF-01 through NF-02.

4.1.1.2.2. Category II: GS-09 through GS-12; Acquisition Demonstration: NH-02, NH-03 (EOCS 61-75); NJ-03 through NJ-04; NK-03; Federal Wage System: WG-10 through WG-14; WL-08 through WL-14; WS-06 through WS-14; Non-appropriated Fund: NF-03 through NF-04.

4.1.1.2.3. Category III: GS-13 through GS-14; Acquisition Demonstration: NH-03 (EOCS ≤76), NH-04 (EOCS ≤ 91); WG, WL, WS-15; Non-appropriated Fund: NF-05.

4.1.1.3. Individual Mobilization Augmentee (IMA) Categories:

4.1.1.3.1. IMA AMN (E-1 through E-4)

4.1.1.3.2. IMA NCO (E-5 through E-6)

4.1.1.3.3. IMA SNCO (E-7 through E-9)

4.1.1.3.4. IMA CGO (O-1 through O-3)

4.1.1.3.5. IMA FGO (O-4 through O-5)

4.2. Eligibility:

4.2.1. Military nominees must:

4.2.1.1. Be recommended by a director/commander or designated representative.

4.2.1.2. Not be enrolled in the Fitness Improvement, the Body Composition, or the Fit-For-Life Program and must currently meet the minimum requirements (composite score of equal to or greater than 75) on the Air Force Fitness Assessment.

4.2.1.3. Not have an unfavorable information file or be on a control roster during the awards period.

4.2.1.4. Not have a court-martial conviction or be pending Article 15 action during the awards period.

4.2.1.5. Assigned to the organization for at least six months of the award period **(IMAs ONLY).**

4.2.1.6. Be nominated in the category of award corresponding to the grade held for the majority of the award period. For example, if a member held the grade of TSgt for seven months of the award period and is then promoted to MSgt, nominate the member in the NCO category.

4.2.2. Civilian nominees must:

4.2.2.1. Be recommended by a director/commander or designated representative.

4.2.2.2. Not have a disciplinary or adverse action during the award period.

4.2.2.3. Assigned to the organization for at least six months of the award period.

4.2.3. Individual Mobilization Augmentee nominees must:

4.2.3.1. Be recommended by a director/commander or designated representative.

4.2.3.2. Not be enrolled in the Fitness Improvement, the Body Composition, or the Fit-For-Life Program and must currently meet the minimum requirements (composite score of equal to or greater than 75) on the Air Force Fitness Assessment.

4.2.3.3. Not have an unfavorable information file or be on a control roster during the awards period.

4.2.3.4. Not have a court-martial conviction or be pending Article 15 action during the awards period.

4.2.3.5. Assigned to the organization for at least six months of the award period.

4.2.3.6. Be nominated in the category of award corresponding to the grade held for the majority of the award period. For example, if a member held the grade of TSgt for seven months of the award period and is then promoted to MSgt, nominate the member in the NCO category.

4.3. Nomination Process. AFSC/A1KD will task AFSC organizations based on AFMC's Annual Excellence Awards call for nominations. The solicitation will also include nomination requirements for the 12 Outstanding Airmen of the Year (OAY) and First Sergeant of the Year (FSOY) awards. NOTE: AFSC enlisted nominees compete for the AFMC Annual Excellence Awards first; and if selected at the HQ AFMC-level; those winners will then compete for the 12 OAY and FSOY awards at Headquarters, Air Force.

4.3.1. Nominations will include the following:

4.3.2. Endorsement Memorandum: Organizations must submit letter to identify nominees by name and award category. The memorandum must state that validation with the nominee's unit was accomplished ensuring that the nominee does not have any derogatory information, also stating verbatim that "A review of the official personnel record was conducted on (date) and revealed no information that would bring discredit to award or the Department of the Air Force during the award period."

4.3.2.1. DAF Form 1206 (pdf): Nomination write-ups are limited to 26 lines in narrative format, single-spaced/typed/12 Font, and two headers that stand alone (Leadership and Job Performance in Primary Duty and Whole Airman Concept (Enlisted/Civilian Only), and Leadership and Job Performance in Primary Duty and Innovation (Officer Only), using the current DAF Form 1206 (pdf). Common acronyms may be used as long as the meaning is clear (TDY, AF, USAFE, SFS, etc.), otherwise acronyms will not be used. The use of an acronym list is not permitted. (Template can be found within the Documents section of ETMS2). The latest version is available at **http://www.e-publishing.af.mil**.

4.3.2.2. A signed Public Release Statement. (Template can be found within the Documents section of ETMS2).

4.3.2.3. A biography, limited to one, single-spaced typewritten page (Template can be found within the Documents section of ETMS2).

4.3.2.4. A citation, limited to 50-70 key words (not including opening and closing statements), that provides specific examples of leadership and job performance; significant self-improvement; and base or community involvement. Refer to DAFMAN 36-2806, *Military Awards,* Figure A18.2. for format. (Template can be found within the Documents section of ETMS2).

4.3.2.5. Official photo as defined in AFMC's Annual Excellence Awards call for nominations.

4.3.2.6. A Statement of Release (Template can be found within the Documents section of ETMS2).

4.3.2.7. Per HQ AFMC, all military nominations must include the following: SURF, up-to-date fitness printout, and official photo in service dress without cap.

4.4. Selection Process:

4.4.1. AFSC/A1KD will assemble an electronic selection board for officers and civilian categories when multiple submissions are received in a particular category.

4.4.2. Board President for civilian categories is AFSC/CA or AFSC/DS.

4.4.3. Board President for military and individual mobilization augmentee categories is as follows:

4.4.3.1. AFSC/CCC for all enlisted categories.

4.4.3.2. AFSC/CD for all officer categories.

4.4.3.3. Boards will consist of three to five members: AFSC/A1KD will request board members for civilian and officer categories through AFSC organization's workflow accounts. AFSC/CCC will conduct the boards for the enlisted nominations.

4.4.4. Board members for civilian and officer categories will typically be comprised of GS-14/NH-04/Lt Col and above and be at least equivalent or one rank/pay-grade above the highest-ranking nominee in any category.

4.4.5. Once board members have been determined, AFSC/A1KD will electronically forward nominations, score sheet, and any other relevant information to include the suspense date.

4.4.5.1. Once the board member scores all the nominations, he/she will forward their completed score sheet to AFSC/A1KD for compiling and determining the AFSC nominee(s).

4.4.5.2. AFSC/A1KD will forward final tally sheets to the respective board president for review/approval.

4.4.5.2.1. AFSC/CCC will conduct the board for enlisted awards and will:

4.4.5.2.2. Receive nomination packages for Airman, NCO, SNCO, First Sergeant, IMA AMN, IMA NCO, and IMA SNCO award categories from the AFSC Awards SharePoint site.

4.4.5.2.3. Solicit and assign members to an enlisted selection board.

4.4.5.2.4. Submit names of Airman, NCO, SNCO, First Sergeant, IMA AMN, IMA NCO, and IMA SNCO category winners to AFSC/A1KD to update the AFSC Awards SharePoint site.

STACEY T. HAWKINS
Lieutenant General, USAF
Commander

Attachment 1

GLOSSARY OF REFERENCES AND SUPPORTING INFORMATION

References

DoDI1400.25v451_DAFI 36-1004, *Civilian Recognition Program*, 26 April 2019

DAFMAN 36-2806, *Military Awards*, 27 October 2022

AFI 33-322, *Records Management and Information Governance Program,* 27 July 2021

AFPC *Awards Guidance for LCC Bases & HAF OL*, February 2013

Abbreviations and Acronyms

AFI—Air Force Instruction

AFMC—Air Force Materiel Command

AFPC—Air Force Personnel Center

AFSC—Air Force Sustainment Center

AMN—Airman

CA—Executive Director

CC—Commander

CCC—Command Chief

CGO—Company Grade Officer

CL—Civilian Leader

CPS—Civilian Personnel Section

CV—Vice Commander

DCPDS—Defense Civilian Personnel Data System

DZP—Personnel Programs Division

DS—Director of Staff

EOCS—Expected Overall Contribution Score

eSSS—Electronic Staff Summary Sheet

ETMS2—Enterprise Task Management Software Solution

FGO—Field Grade Officer

GS—General Schedule

HAF—Headquarters, Air Force

HQ—Headquarters

IAW—In Accordance With

IMA—Individual Mobilization Augmentee

LCC—Large Civilian Center

NCO—Noncommissioned Officer

NH—Business Management & Technical Management Profession

NJ—Technical Management Support

NK—Administrative Support

OCR—Office of Coordinating Responsibility

OL—Operating Location

SA/SA—Special Act or Service Award

SNCO—Senior Noncommissioned Officer

TOA—Time-off Award

WG—Wage Grade

WL—Work Leader

WS—Work Supervisor